

UNIVERSITY OF BRISTOL

Winter 2024 Examination Period

SCHOOL OF COMPUTER SCIENCE

**Second Year PRACTICE Examination for the Degrees
of
Bachelor of Science
Master of Engineering**

**COMS20007W
Programming Languages and Computation**

**TIME ALLOWED:
3 Hours**

This paper contains *three* questions, worth *40*, *30* and *30* marks respectively. Answer *all* questions. The maximum for this paper is *100 marks*. Credit will be given for partial answers.

Other Instructions:

Candidates may bring to the exam room 1 double-sided A4 page of notes in any format. A reminder of key definitions is provided at the back of this paper.

TURN OVER ONLY WHEN TOLD TO START WRITING

Q1. This question is about syntax.

- *(a) Consider the following grammar over terminal symbols $\{a, b\}$:

$$S \longrightarrow aSa \mid bSb \mid \epsilon$$

- i. Give two examples of words over $\{a, b\}$ that are derivable in the grammar.
- ii. Give two examples of words over $\{a, b\}$ that are not derivable in the grammar.
- iii. Is the following statement true or false? Every word derivable in the grammar has even length.

[5 marks]

- *(b) Consider each of the following grammars over the alphabet $\{a, b, c\}$. In each case, the start symbol is S .

1.

$$S \longrightarrow aSaS \mid bS \mid cS \mid \epsilon$$

2.

$$\begin{aligned} S &\longrightarrow TabbT \mid TbbaT \\ T &\longrightarrow aT \mid bT \mid cT \mid \epsilon \end{aligned}$$

3.

$$\begin{aligned} S &\longrightarrow bTb \\ T &\longrightarrow aT \mid bT \mid cT \mid \epsilon \end{aligned}$$

4.

$$\begin{aligned} S &\longrightarrow XSX \mid \epsilon \\ X &\longrightarrow a \mid b \mid c \end{aligned}$$

5.

$$S \longrightarrow bS \mid cS \mid \epsilon$$

Match each of the following descriptions of languages to the regular expression above that denotes it:

- i. The language of all words that start and end with b .
- ii. The language of all words that do not contain a .
- iii. The language of all even length words.
- iv. The language of all words containing an even number of a .
- v. The language of all words that either contain abb or bba as a substring.

[5 marks]

- *(c) Consider the following grammar for the syntax of Combinatory Logic:

$$M \longrightarrow \text{var} \mid k \mid s \mid M M \mid (M)$$

whose 5 terminal symbols are:

$$\text{var} \quad k \quad s \quad (\quad)$$

(cont.)

- i. Compute nullable, and the first and follow sets for this grammar.
- ii. Draw the parse table for this grammar.
- iii. Is the grammar LL(1)?

[10 marks]

** (d) For each of the following sets of words over $\{a, b\}$, design a context-free grammar that expresses the set:

- i. All words whose length is a multiple of 3, e.g. *abb*, *ababba*.
- ii. All words that start and end with a different letter, e.g. *abbaab*.
- iii. All words that contain a letter *b* exactly two places from the end, e.g. *aabab*, *baa*.
- iv. All words that do not contain the substring *aa*.

[6 marks]

** (e) Give an LL(1) grammar equivalent to the following context-free grammar:

$$S \longrightarrow \emptyset \mid (S) \mid \text{atom} \mid S \cup S \mid S \cap S \mid S^c$$

whose terminal symbols are:

$$\emptyset \quad (\quad) \quad \text{atom} \quad \cup \quad \cap \quad ^c$$

[4 marks]

*** (f) Show that the following language over $\{0, 1\}$ can be expressed by a context-free grammar and justify your construction.

$$\{1^k w \mid k \geq 1, w \in \Sigma^*, \#_1(w) \geq k\}$$

where $\#_1(v)$ counts the number of 1 characters in the word v , e.g. $\#_1(00101110) = 3$.

[5 marks]

*** (g) Define the following indexed family of words w_i by recursion on $i \in \mathbb{N}$:

$$w_0 = a$$

$$w_{k+1} = a + w_k$$

For example, $w_3 = a + a + a + a$ and $w_5 = a + a + a + a + a + a$.

Prove that every word in the language $\{w_i \mid i \in \mathbb{N}\}$ is derivable in the following grammar (whose start symbol is S):

$$\begin{aligned} S &\longrightarrow a U \\ U &\longrightarrow + a U \mid \epsilon \end{aligned}$$

[5 marks]

Q2. This question is about semantics.

- * (a) For each of the following, indicate whether it represents a valid arithmetic expression, a valid Boolean expression, or neither. In each case, if the expression is valid, evaluate the appropriate denotation function in the state $[x \mapsto 1, y \mapsto 2, z \mapsto 3]$.

- i. $x + 10 < 6 * (-42 - y)$
- ii. $x \leftarrow z - (42 + y)$
- iii. $\text{true} \ \&\& \ (\text{false} \ || \ 42 * x < 0)$
- iv. $\text{true} = \text{true}$
- v. $w * 2 = c + d$

[5 marks]

- ** (b) Suppose we add a new form of arithmetic expressions — the *integer exponentiation* operator so that the grammar of arithmetic expressions is now defined as follows:

$$A \longrightarrow n \mid x \mid A + A \mid A - A \mid A * A \mid A \wedge A$$

We extended the denotation function for arithmetic expressions with the equation:

$$\llbracket e_1 \wedge e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) < 0 \\ \llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

- i. Find two arithmetic expressions $e_1 \in \mathcal{A}$ and $e_2 \in \mathcal{A}$ such that the arithmetic expression $x \wedge (e_1 + e_2)$ is *not* semantically equivalent to the arithmetic expression $(x \wedge e_1) \cdot (x \wedge e_2)$.
- ii. Prove that the arithmetic expression $e \wedge 2$ is semantically equivalent to the arithmetic expression $e * e$ for an any given arithmetic expression $e \in \mathcal{A}$.
- iii. Let $S_1 \in \mathcal{S}$ and $S_2 \in \mathcal{S}$ be arbitrary While statements. Prove that “ $\langle \text{if } x = 1 \text{ then } x \leftarrow x \wedge x; S_1 \text{ else } S_2, \sigma \rangle \rightarrow^* \sigma' \rangle$ ” if, and only if, the statement “ $\langle \text{if } x = 1 \text{ then } x \leftarrow x \wedge x; S_1 \text{ else } S_2, \sigma \rangle \rightarrow^* \sigma' \rangle$ ”.

[10 marks]

- *** (c) Consider the While program shown in Figure 1.

```
while  $b \leq a$  do
   $a \leftarrow a - b$ ;
   $q \leftarrow q + 1$ 
```

Figure 1: A simple While program

- i. For each of the following states, indicate whether the program terminates when executed in that initial state, and the values of q and a in the final state (if it exists). You do not need to state the corresponding trace.
 1. $[a \mapsto 25, b \mapsto 3]$

(cont.)

2. $[a \mapsto 25, b \mapsto -12]$

3. $[a \mapsto 25, b \mapsto 0]$

4. $[a \mapsto -25, b \mapsto 10]$

5. $[a \mapsto 10, b \mapsto 3]$

ii. Find a loop invariant I from which you may conclude:

$$\{a = n \ \&\& \ q = 0\} \ P \ \{n < b * (q + 1)\}$$

for some fixed integer $n \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Justify why I is a loop invariant in relation to the strongest post-condition of the loops body, and how it can be used to conclude the above triple.

[15 marks]

Q3. This question is about computability.

* (a) Show that the function $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ defined by

$$f(x) \begin{cases} \simeq 2^x - 1 & \text{if } x \text{ is even} \\ \uparrow & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

is computable.

[5 marks]

* (b) State whether each of the following statements is true or false.

- The set of prime numbers is decidable.
- If a function has an inverse, it must be an injection.
- Every surjection has an inverse.
- WHILE programs compute partial functions.
- If a function is computable then it must be an injection.

[5 marks]

** (c) Let $f : A \rightarrow B$ and $g : B \rightarrow C$. Show that if $g \circ f : A \rightarrow C$ is injective, then so is f .

[3 marks]

** (d) Show that the predicate

$$U = \{ \ulcorner S \urcorner \mid \text{for all } k \leq 2023 \text{ it is true that } \llbracket S \rrbracket_x(k) = \llbracket S \rrbracket_x(k+1) \}$$

is semi-decidable. (The use of “=” here means that both sides of the equality must be defined and equal.)

[5 marks]

*** (e) Show that the predicate

$$V = \{ \ulcorner S \urcorner \mid \text{there exists } k \in \mathbb{N} \text{ such that } \llbracket S \rrbracket_x(k) = \llbracket S \rrbracket_x(k+1) \}$$

is undecidable (The use of “=” here means that both sides of the equality must be defined and equal.)

[5 marks]

*** (f) Show that the following predicate is undecidable:

$$P = \{ \langle \ulcorner S_1 \urcorner, \ulcorner S_2 \urcorner \rangle \mid \text{for all } n \in \mathbb{N}: \llbracket S_1 \rrbracket_x(n) \simeq 1 \text{ iff } \llbracket S_2 \rrbracket_x(n) \simeq k \text{ where } k \neq 1 \}$$

[7 marks]

Reminder of Important Definitions

Grammars

A *Context Free Grammar (CFG)* consists of four components:

- An alphabet of *terminal* symbols.
- A finite, non-empty set of *non-terminal* symbols, disjoint from the terminals.
- A finite set of *production rules*.
- A designated non-terminal called the *start symbol*.

A *sentential form*, usually α , β , γ and so on, is just a finite sequence of terminals and nonterminals.

The sentential form α can make a *derivation step* to β , written $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$, just if:

- α has shape $\gamma_1 X \gamma_2$ and β has shape $\gamma_1 \delta \gamma_2$
- and there is a production rule $X ::= \delta$ in the grammar

A *derivation sequence* is a non-empty sequence of sentential forms $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \dots, \alpha_{k-1}, \alpha_k$ in which consecutive elements of the sequence are derivation steps:

$$\alpha_1 \rightarrow \alpha_2 \rightarrow \dots \rightarrow \alpha_{k-1} \rightarrow \alpha_k$$

A sentential form β is *derivable* from α , written $\alpha \rightarrow^* \beta$ just if there is a derivation sequence starting with α and ending with β .

We say that a word w is in the *language of a grammar* G with start symbol S , and write $w \in L(G)$ just if $S \rightarrow^* w$.

Nullable

On nonterminals:

$$\text{Nullable}(X) \text{ iff } X \rightarrow^* \epsilon$$

On sentential forms:

$$\text{Nullable}_s(\alpha) = \begin{cases} \text{true} & \text{if } \alpha = \epsilon \\ \text{false} & \text{if } \alpha \text{ is of shape } a\beta \\ \text{Nullable}(X) \wedge \text{Nullable}_s(\beta) & \text{if } \alpha \text{ is of shape } X\beta \end{cases}$$

(cont.)

First

On nonterminals:

$$\text{First}(X) = \{a \mid \exists \beta. X \rightarrow^* a\beta\}$$

On sentential forms:

$$\text{First}_s(\alpha) = \begin{cases} \emptyset & \text{if } \alpha = \epsilon \\ \{a\} & \text{if } \alpha \text{ is of shape } a\beta \\ \text{First}(X) & \text{if } \alpha \text{ is of shape } X\beta \text{ and } \neg \text{Nullable}(X) \\ \text{First}(X) \cup \text{First}_s(\beta) & \text{if } \alpha \text{ is of shape } X\beta \text{ and } \text{Nullable}(X) \end{cases}$$

Follow

On nonterminals:

$$\text{Follow}(X) = \{a \mid \exists \alpha\beta. S \rightarrow^* \alpha X a \beta\}$$

Parse Tables and LL(1)

We define the *parsing table*, usually T , for a given grammar as a 2d array indexed by pairs of a nonterminal and a terminal. Each entry $T[X, a]$ is a set of production rules from the grammar, such that some rule $X \rightarrow \beta$ is in the set $T[X, a]$ just if, either:

1. $a \in \text{First}_s(\beta)$
2. or, $\text{Nullable}_s(\beta)$ and $a \in \text{Follow}(X)$

A grammar whose parsing table contains at most one rule in each cell is called *LL(1)*.

Abstract Syntax of Arithmetic Expressions

An *arithmetic expression* is a tree described by the following grammar:

$$A ::= n \mid x \mid A + A \mid A - A \mid A * A$$

where n ranges over integer literals, and x ranges over variables. Parentheses are used to resolve ambiguity and to indicate the structure of the tree. We write $\mathcal{A}$ for the set of arithmetic expressions.

Abstract Syntax of Boolean Expressions

A *Boolean expression* is a tree described by the following grammar.

$$B ::= \text{false} \mid \text{true} \mid !B \mid B \ \&\& \ B \mid B \ || \ B \mid A = A \mid A \leq A$$

Parentheses are used to resolve ambiguity and to indicate the structure of the tree. We write $\mathcal{B}$ for the set of Boolean expressions.

Abstract Syntax of Statements

A *statement* is a tree described by the following grammar:

$$S ::= \text{skip} \mid x \leftarrow A \mid S; S \mid \text{if } B \text{ then } S \text{ else } S \mid \text{while } B \text{ do } S$$

Braces “ $\{\dots\}$ ” are used to resolve ambiguity and to indicate the structure of the tree. We write $\mathcal{S}$ for the set of statements.

States

A *state* is a total function from the set $\text{State} = \text{Var} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$, where Var is the set of variables. We write $[x_1 \mapsto v_1, x_2 \mapsto v_2, \dots, x_n \mapsto v_n]$ to indicate the state that maps the variable $x_i \in \text{Var}$ to the value $v_i \in \mathbb{Z}$ for all $i \leq n$. By convention, any variable not explicitly mentioned by a given state σ is assigned the value 0.

For a given state $\sigma \in \text{State}$, we write $\sigma[x \mapsto v]$ for some variable $x \in \text{Var}$ and $v \in \mathbb{Z}$ to denote the state that maps the variable x to v and any other variable y to the value $\sigma(y)$.

Semantics of Arithmetic Expressions

The denotation function for arithmetic expressions $\llbracket \cdot \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}} \in \mathcal{A} \rightarrow (\text{State} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z})$, which is defined by recursion in Figure 2. We say that two arithmetic expressions $e_1, e_2 \in \mathcal{A}$ are *semantically equivalent* if, and only if, $\llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) = \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma)$ for all states $\sigma \in \text{State}$.

$$\begin{aligned} \llbracket n \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) &= n \\ \llbracket x \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) &= \sigma(x) \\ \llbracket e_1 + e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) &= \llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) + \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) \\ \llbracket e_1 - e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) &= \llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) - \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) \\ \llbracket e_1 * e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) &= \llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) \cdot \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) \end{aligned}$$

Figure 2: Definition of the denotational semantics of arithmetic expressions.

Semantics of Boolean Expressions

The denotation function for Boolean expressions $\llbracket \cdot \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}} \in \mathcal{B} \rightarrow (\text{State} \rightarrow \mathbb{B})$ is defined by recursion in Figure 3. We say that two Boolean expressions $e_1, e_2 \in \mathcal{B}$ are *semantically equivalent* if, and only if, $\llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) = \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma)$ for all states $\sigma \in \text{State}$.

(cont.)

$$\begin{aligned}
\llbracket \text{false} \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) &= \perp \\
\llbracket \text{true} \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) &= \top \\
\llbracket !e \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) &= \neg \llbracket e \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) \\
\llbracket e_1 \ \&\& \ e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) &= \llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) \wedge \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) \\
\llbracket e_1 \ \parallel \ e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) &= \llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) \vee \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) \\
\llbracket e_1 = e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) &= \llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) = \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) \\
\llbracket e_1 \leq e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) &= \llbracket e_1 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma) \leq \llbracket e_2 \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma)
\end{aligned}$$

Figure 3: Definition of the denotational semantics of Boolean expressions.

Semantics of Statements

The small-step operational semantics relation $\rightarrow \subseteq \mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{C}$ is defined by the rules in Figure 4 where the set of configurations $\mathcal{C}$ is $(\mathcal{S} \times \text{State}) \cup \text{State}$.

$$\begin{array}{c}
\frac{}{\langle \text{skip}, \sigma \rangle \rightarrow \sigma} \qquad \frac{}{\langle x \leftarrow e, \sigma \rangle \rightarrow \sigma[x \mapsto \llbracket e \rrbracket_{\mathcal{A}}(\sigma)]} \\
\\
\frac{\langle S_1, \sigma_1 \rangle \rightarrow \langle S'_1, \sigma_2 \rangle}{\langle S_1; S_2, \sigma_1 \rangle \rightarrow \langle S'_1; S_2, \sigma_2 \rangle} \qquad \frac{\langle S_1, \sigma_1 \rangle \rightarrow \sigma_2}{\langle S_1; S_2, \sigma_1 \rangle \rightarrow \langle S_2, \sigma_2 \rangle} \\
\\
\frac{}{\langle \text{if } e \text{ then } S_1 \text{ else } S_2, \sigma \rangle \rightarrow \langle S_1, \sigma \rangle} \llbracket e \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) = \top \\
\\
\frac{}{\langle \text{if } e \text{ then } S_1 \text{ else } S_2, \sigma \rangle \rightarrow \langle S_2, \sigma \rangle} \llbracket e \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) = \perp \\
\\
\frac{}{\langle \text{while } e \text{ do } S, \sigma \rangle \rightarrow \langle S; \text{while } e \text{ do } S, \sigma \rangle} \llbracket e \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) = \top \\
\\
\frac{}{\langle \text{while } e \text{ do } S, \sigma \rangle \rightarrow \sigma} \llbracket e \rrbracket_{\mathcal{B}}(\sigma) = \perp
\end{array}$$

Figure 4: Definition of the operational semantics of statements.

Hoare Triples

A Hoare triple $\{P\} \ S \ \{Q\}$ for $P, Q \subseteq \text{State}$ asserts that, for any state $\sigma \in \text{State}$, if $\sigma \in P$ and $\langle S, \sigma \rangle \rightarrow^* \sigma'$, then $\sigma' \in Q$. The sets P and Q can be represented as Boolean expressions extended with quantifiers.

The rules for constructing Hoare triples are given in Figure 5.

$$\begin{array}{c}
\frac{}{\{P\} \text{ skip } \{P\}} \qquad \frac{}{\{P\} x \leftarrow e \{ \exists x'. P[x'/x] \ \&\& \ x = e[x'/x] \}} \\
\\
\frac{\{P\} S_1 \{Q\} \quad \{Q\} S_2 \{R\}}{\{P\} S_1; S_2 \{R\}} \qquad \frac{\{P \ \&\& \ e\} S_1 \{Q_1\} \quad \{P \ \&\& \ !e\} S_2 \{Q_2\}}{\{P\} \text{ if } e \text{ then } S_1 \text{ else } S_2 \{Q_1 \parallel Q_2\}} \\
\\
\frac{\{P \ \&\& \ e\} S \{P\}}{\{P\} \text{ while } e \text{ do } S \{P \ \&\& \ !e\}} \qquad \frac{\{P_1\} S \{Q_1\} \quad P_2 \subseteq P_1}{\{P_2\} S \{Q_2\} \quad Q_1 \subseteq Q_2}
\end{array}$$

Figure 5: Rules of Hoare logic.

Computable Functions

We write $[x \mapsto n]$ for the state that maps the variable x to the number $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and every other variable to 0.

A 'while' program S *computes* a partial function $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ (with respect to x) just if $f(m) \simeq n$ exactly when $\langle S, [x \mapsto m] \rangle \Downarrow [x \mapsto n]$.

A function $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ is *computable* just if there is a program S that computes f with respect to the variable x .

Predicates

The *characteristic function* of U is the function

$$\begin{aligned}
\chi_U : \mathbb{N} &\rightarrow \mathbb{N} \\
\chi_U(n) &= \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } n \in U \\ 0 & \text{if } n \notin U \end{cases}
\end{aligned}$$

The *semi-characteristic function* of U is the partial function

$$\begin{aligned}
\xi_U : \mathbb{N} &\rightarrow \mathbb{N} \\
\xi_U(n) &\begin{cases} \simeq 1 & \text{if } n \in U \\ \uparrow & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}
\end{aligned}$$

A predicate $U \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ is *decidable* just if its characteristic function $\chi_U : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ is computable.

The 'while' program that computes the characteristic function χ_U of a predicate $U \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ is called a *decision procedure*. Any predicate for which there is no decision procedure is called *undecidable*.

(cont.)

A predicate $U \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ is *semi-decidable* just if its semi-characteristic function ξ_U is computable.

The *Halting Problem* is the following predicate:

$$\text{HALT} = \{\langle \ulcorner S \urcorner, n \rangle \mid \llbracket S \rrbracket_{\mathbf{x}}(n) \downarrow\}$$

Bijections

A function $f : A \rightarrow B$ is *injective* (or 1-1) just if for any $a_1, a_2 \in \mathcal{A}$ we have that $f(a_1) = f(a_2)$ implies $a_1 = a_2$. We sometimes write $f : A \rightarrowtail B$ whenever f is an injection.

A function $f : A \rightarrow B$ is *surjective* just if for any $b \in \mathcal{B}$ there exists $a \in \mathcal{A}$ such that $f(a) = b$. We sometimes write $f : A \twoheadrightarrow B$ whenever f is a surjection.

A function $f : A \rightarrow B$ is a *bijection* just if it is both injective and surjective.

Let $f : A \rightarrow B$ be a function. f is an *isomorphism* just if it has an *inverse*. That is, if there exists a function $f^{-1} : B \rightarrow A$ such that:

- for all $a \in \mathcal{A}$ we have $f^{-1}(f(a)) = a$
- for all $b \in \mathcal{B}$ we have $f(f^{-1}(b)) = b$

Encoding Data

A *pairing function* is a bijection $\mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{N}$. We assume that we have a fixed pairing function

$$\langle -, - \rangle : \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{N}$$

with the following inverse:

$$\text{split} : \mathbb{N} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{N} \times \mathbb{N}$$

Reflections

Suppose we have two bijections:

$$\phi : A \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{N} \quad \psi : B \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{N}$$

The *reflection* of $f : A \rightarrow B$ under (ϕ, ψ) is the function

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{f} : \mathbb{N} &\rightarrow \mathbb{N} \\ \tilde{f}(n) &= \psi(f(\phi^{-1}(n))) \end{aligned}$$

Gödel Numbering

Let **Stmt** be the set of Abstract Syntax Trees of While. We assume that we have a Gödel numbering

$$\ulcorner _ \urcorner : \mathbf{Stmt} \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathbb{N}$$

which encodes While programs as natural numbers.

A *code transformation* is a function $f : \mathbf{Stmt} \rightarrow \mathbf{Stmt}$.

Universal Function

The *universal function*, U , is defined as follows:

$$U : \mathbf{Stmt} \times \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$$

$$U(P, n) = \llbracket P \rrbracket_x(n)$$

Reductions

Let $U, W \subseteq \mathbb{N}$ be predicates, and let $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$. The function f is a *many-one reduction* from U to W just if it is computable, and it is also the case that

$$n \in U \Leftrightarrow f(n) \in W$$

We may write $f : U \lesssim V$ (read " f is a reduction from U to V ").